UX/UI CASE STUDY · NEWTONITE DESIGN ASSIGNMENT

Sprout 2.0

Student Execution Plan

Manansh Gupta · UX/UI design direction, mascot, design system, prototype

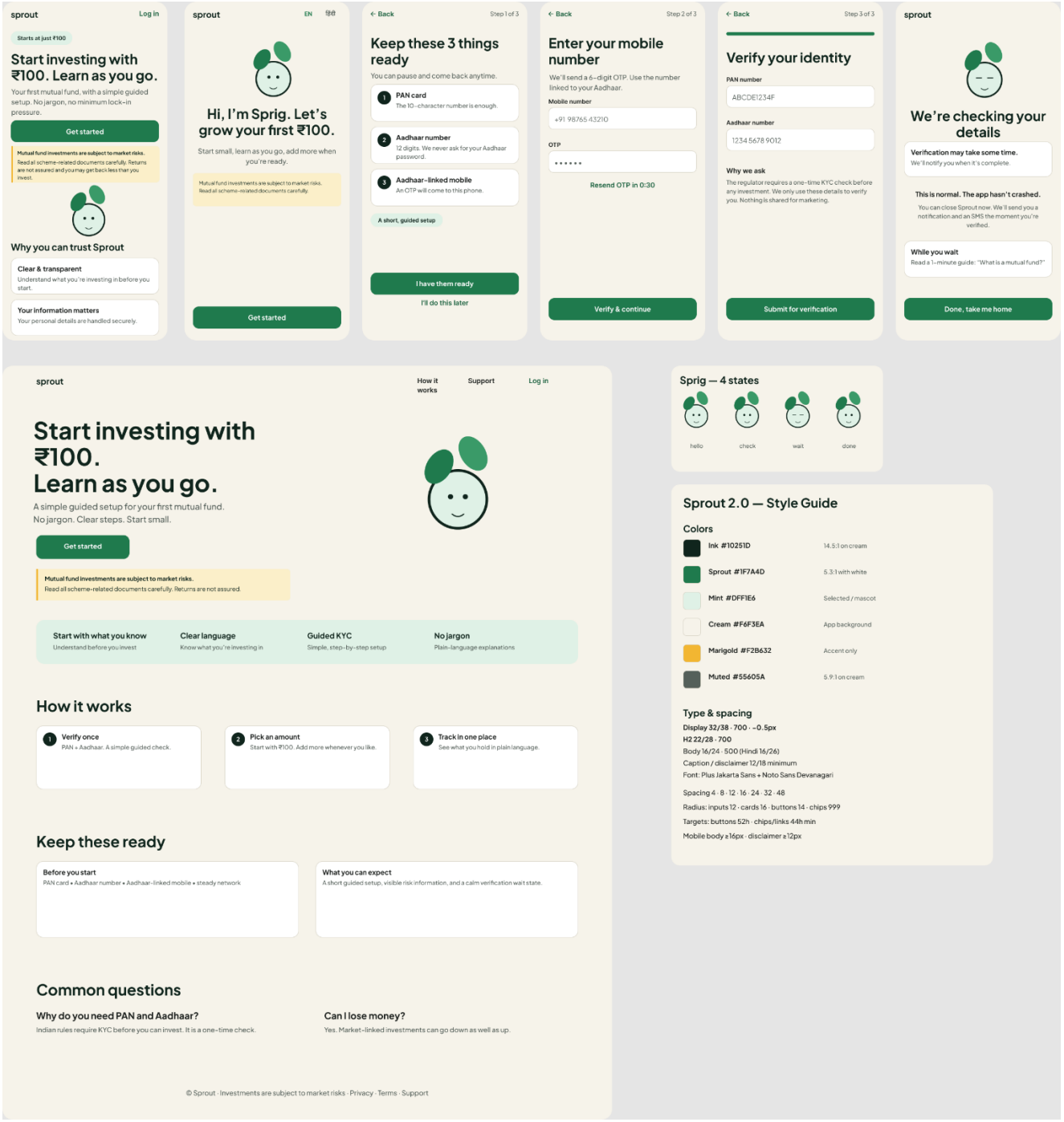
> **Design challenge:** How might we help first-time investors in India get from download to verified KYC and a first ₹100 investment, without misleading anyone about risk?

Final product overview

Deliverable	What it is
Mobile homepage (390 × 800)	Hero, trust section, how it works, "Keep these ready" checklist, common questions, footer
Desktop homepage (1440px)	Same system and copy on a 12-column grid
5 onboarding screens	Welcome → What You Need → OTP → KYC → Waiting
Sprig mascot	One geometric mascot with 4 states
Style guide + prototype	Colour, type, spacing, components; clickable mobile flow ending back at Home

1. Sprout 2.0 — The Final Experience

A SIMPLE, TRUSTWORTHY JOURNEY FROM DISCOVERY TO VERIFICATION



2. Problem and design question

CONTEXT, EVIDENCE, AND WHAT IS ONLY A HYPOTHESIS

Context

- Sprout 2.0 is an investing app for first-time investors in India, starting from ₹100.
- Users must complete KYC (PAN + Aadhaar) before investing, so the path from download to first investment is long.
- 91% of users are on mobile, so the design starts mobile-first.

Design question

> How might we get more downloads through KYC to a first investment, while keeping the risk disclosure clear and the build realistic for 1 developer in about 3 weeks?

Evidence, labelled

FACT Funnel: 40,000 downloads → 9,000 KYC starts → 3,000 first investments.

FACT A 62% KYC drop-off is reported. Its cause has **not** been confirmed.

FACT Support complaints say users are not ready with PAN/Aadhaar and that the waiting screen looks like a crash.

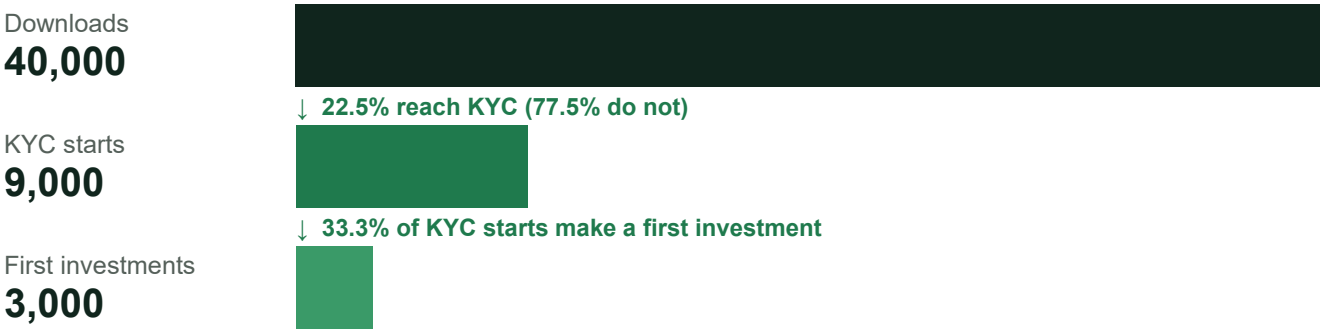
HYPOTHESIS Missing documents and an unclear waiting state contribute to the KYC drop-off. These are inferred from support feedback, not tested.

HYPOTHESIS The 78% bounce rate is noisy because a paid campaign affected it, so it is not used as a primary design driver.

No user research or interviews were run for this case study.

3. Data audit and funnel

WHAT THE DATA CAN AND CANNOT TELL US



Download → first investment overall: **7.5%**. Bars are drawn to scale.

Step	Calculation	Rate
Download → KYC	9,000 ÷ 40,000	22.5%
KYC → first investment	3,000 ÷ 9,000	33.3%
Download → first investment	3,000 ÷ 40,000	7.5%

How each number was treated

Data point	Status	Treatment
78% bounce rate	Noisy	A paid ad campaign affected it. Not used as a primary design driver.
62% KYC drop-off	Cause unconfirmed	Possible causes are hypotheses from support feedback: documents not ready, and the waiting state creating uncertainty.
Support complaints	Qualitative	Direction only. Not a measured result.

Why download → KYC comes first

- Largest absolute loss: 31,000 of 40,000 users (77.5%).
- It sits upstream of every first investment.
- Both suspected causes (readiness, waiting clarity) are design-addressable.

The data can tell us	The data cannot tell us
Where the largest drop in volume is	Why users leave KYC
The step-to-step conversion rates	Whether the bounce rate reflects the product or the ad campaign
That support hears about readiness and the waiting state	How many users each complaint represents

4. Users and journey

PROTO-PERSONAS / WORKING ASSUMPTIONS

ASSUMPTION These are **proto-personas / working assumptions** built from the brief and support themes. They are not interviewed users.

Aarav
Proto-persona · 22

SITUATION
Student or first job, small budget

NEED
Start with ₹100, no jargon

PAIN POINT
Fear of looking foolish

DESIGN RESPONSE
₹100 hero, plain words

Meena
Proto-persona · 34

SITUATION
Salaried, Hindi-first, cautious

NEED
Trust and Hindi text

PAIN POINT
Fear of being misled

DESIGN RESPONSE
Trust section, Hindi-ready layout, visible disclaimer

Rohit
Proto-persona · 27

SITUATION
Wants to try, easily distracted

NEED
Speed, minimal steps

PAIN POINT
Fear of wasted time

DESIGN RESPONSE
One clear CTA: "Get started"

User journey

The friction row is a **hypothesis** from the brief and support themes, not tested.

STAGE	1 Discover	2 Trust check	3 Prepare	4 Sign up	5 KYC	6 Wait
USER DOES	Lands on homepage	Scans for legitimacy	Decides to start	Mobile + OTP	PAN + Aadhaar	Verification pending
LIKELY FRICTION (hypothesis)	Unclear what Sprout is	Unsure how their data is handled	Missing PAN/Aadhaar	Wrong mobile for Aadhaar	Doesn’t know why	Looks like a crash
DESIGN RESPONSE	One hero message + ₹100	Trust section + visible disclaimer	"Keep these ready" checklist	Copy says "Aadhaar-linked mobile"	Progress bar + "Why we ask"	Sprig motion + clear status message + notification + SMS reassurance

5. Stakeholder decisions

THE FINAL DESIGN IS A COMPROMISE

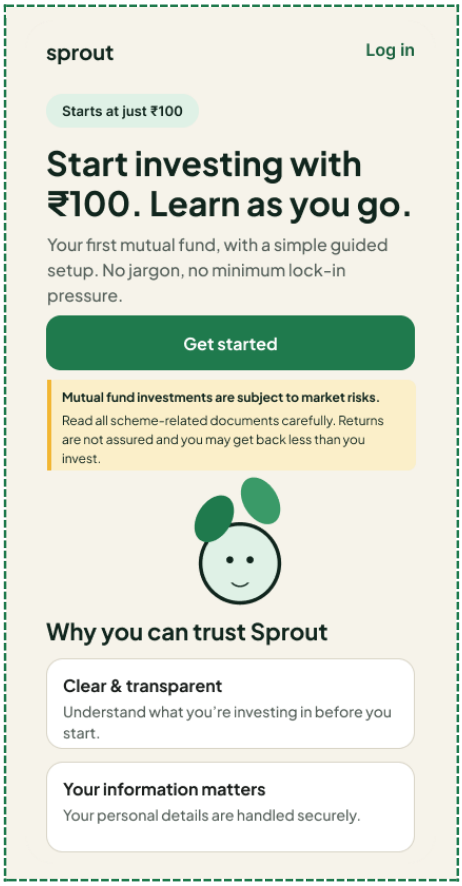
Stakeholder	Conflict	Decision	Design consequence
CEO	Wants minimal and premium, not a cartoon	Adopted	Cream/ink/green palette, generous whitespace, geometric mascot
Marketing	Wants the Sprig mascot, plus video, ticker and popups	Mascot adopted, limited. Video, ticker, popups declined	Sprig appears at Welcome and Waiting. No distracting motion elsewhere
Compliance	Needs a visible risk disclaimer and no misleading investment language	Adopted	Disclaimer strip under the hero CTA and on Welcome; neutral, plain wording
Developer	1 developer, about 3 weeks, page-size limits	Adopted	Simple components, inline SVG mascot, CSS-only motion, no video
Support	Users unprepared for KYC; waiting looks like a crash	Adopted	"Keep these ready" checklist; calm, transparent waiting screen

Trade-off logic: no single stakeholder got everything. Where a request conflicted with trust, compliance or the build limit, trust, compliance and the build limit won. Referral elements were deferred because they are not relevant before KYC.

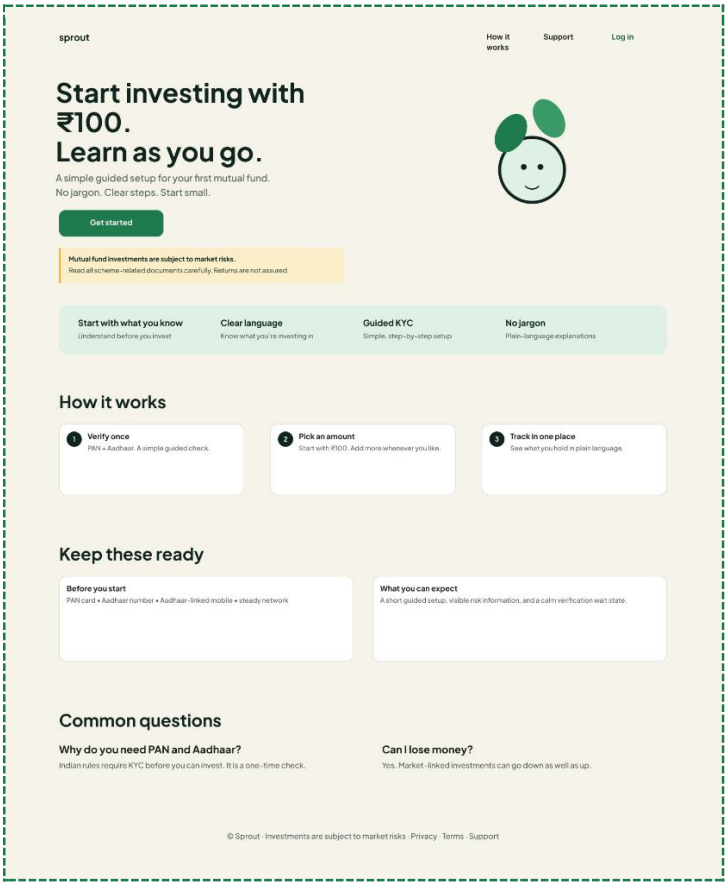
Request not adopted	Why
Video	Page weight and build time; the page-size limit is under 1.5MB
Live ticker	Conflicts with compliance and adds distraction for a first-time investor
Popups	Interrupt the path to KYC and reduce trust
Referral elements	Deferred; revisit after the first investment

6. Homepage design

HIERARCHY, CTA, TRUST, DISCLAIMER, READINESS



Mobile homepage (390 × 800).



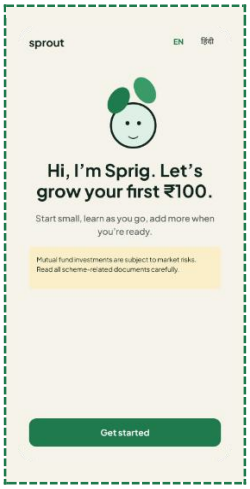
Desktop homepage (1440px, 12-column grid, 1120px content).

Element	Decision	Why
Hero	"Starts at just ₹100" + "Start investing with ₹100. Learn as you go."	Leads with the entry price; "learn" signals no pressure
Primary CTA	One CTA: "Get started"	One clear action; no duration claim
Risk disclaimer	Visible strip right under the CTA, no scrolling needed. 12px+ mobile, 14px desktop	Compliance requirement; also sets honest expectations
Trust section	"Clear & transparent", "Your information matters", "Plain-language guidance"	Reassures without unconfirmed factual claims. Final legal/product wording to be confirmed before launch
How it works	3 steps: verify once, pick an amount, track in one place	Shows the path before asking for effort
"Keep these ready"	PAN, Aadhaar number, Aadhaar-linked mobile, steady network	Targets the readiness hypothesis
Common questions	Includes "Can I lose money?" answered plainly: yes	Honest answer builds trust
Desktop	Same copy and system on a 12-column grid, 6/6 hero	Consistent story across devices

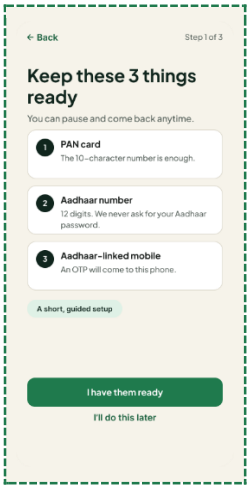
> **Funnel link:** the homepage targets download → KYC by setting expectations (what is needed, what the risk is) before the user starts verification.

7. Onboarding design

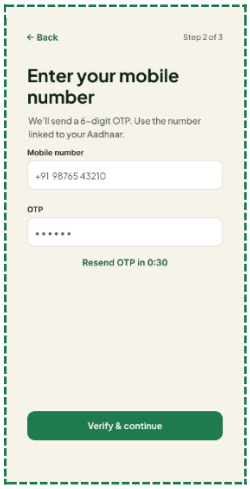
FIVE SCREENS, ONE JOB EACH



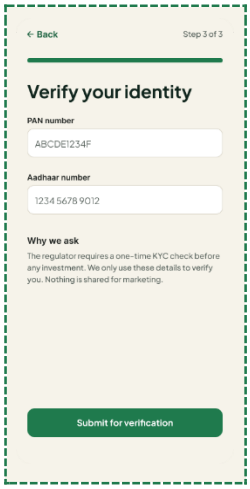
1. Welcome



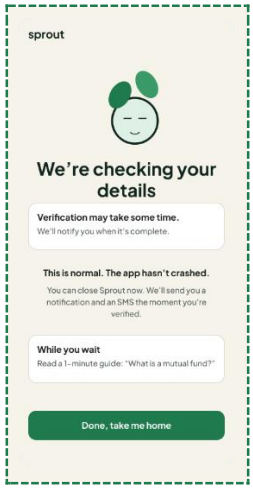
2. What You Need



3. OTP



4. KYC



5. Waiting

Screen	User problem	Design decision	Rationale / expected effect (to validate)
1 Welcome	First step may feel intimidating (assumption)	Sprig + "Hi, I'm Sprig. Let's grow your first ₹100." + EN/हिंदी toggle + disclaimer	Warm but not childish; language choice up front; risk visible. More users continue to Screen 2
2 What You Need	Users start KYC without documents ready (hypothesis)	Numbered cards: PAN, Aadhaar number, Aadhaar-linked mobile. "I'll do this later" exit	Readiness before effort; leaving becomes a choice, not a dead end. Fewer mid-KYC exits from missing documents
3 OTP	Wrong mobile or typing errors (assumption)	Labelled mobile and OTP fields, numeric input, resend control, "Aadhaar-linked" wording	Reduces avoidable errors. Fewer failed OTP attempts
4 KYC	Unclear why sensitive details are needed	PAN + Aadhaar fields, "Step 3 of 3" progress bar, "Why we ask" open by default	Explains purpose at the moment of hesitation. Higher KYC completion
5 Waiting	Waiting looks like a crash (hypothesis)	Animated Sprig + final copy below + "While you wait"	Motion shows the app is alive. Fewer "app crashed" contacts

> **Waiting screen copy:** "We're checking your details." "Verification may take some time. We'll notify you when it's complete." "This is normal. The app hasn't crashed. You can close Sprout now. We'll send you a notification and an SMS the moment you're verified."

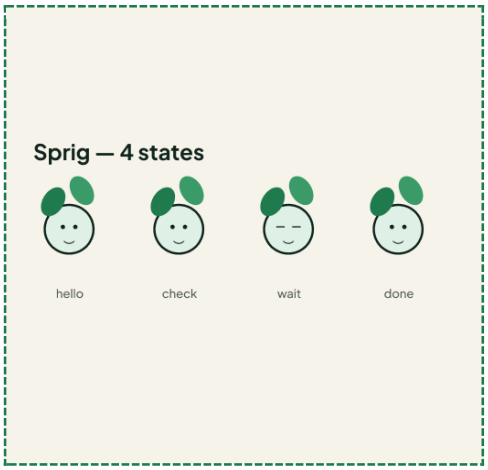
8. Visual system and accessibility

ONE LANGUAGE ACROSS HOMEPAGE AND ONBOARDING

	Colour	Hex	Role	Contrast (calculated)
	Ink	#10251D	Headings, dark surfaces	Ink on Cream 14.5:1 · Ink on Mint 13.7:1
	Sprout	#1F7A4D	Primary CTA	White on Sprout 5.3:1 · Sprout on Cream 4.8:1
	Mint	#DFF1E6	Selected states, mascot body	See Ink on Mint
	Cream	#F6F3EA	App background	Cream on Ink 14.5:1
	Marigold	#F2B632	Disclaimer accent only, never text	Ink on Marigold 8.8:1
	Muted	#55605A	Secondary text	Muted on Cream 5.9:1

Type	Spec
Fonts	Plus Jakarta Sans + Noto Sans Devanagari
Display / H2	32/38 / 22/28
Body	16/24 (Hindi approx. 16/26)
Caption / disclaimer	Minimum 12/18

Area	Decision
Spacing + shape	4-pt scale; mobile side margin 16; desktop 12 columns, 1120px, 24 gutters; radius: inputs 12, cards 16, buttons 14
Components	Primary button (52px mobile, 56px desktop), link button, language chips, cards, labelled inputs, progress bar, accordions, disclaimer strip, checklist
Contrast targets	Normal text ≥ 4.5:1; large text ≥ 3:1. All pairs above meet these
Touch + text	Tap targets about 44×44px or larger; mobile body ≥ 16px
Hindi / localisation	Layout tolerates about 30% longer text: flexible-height containers, wrapping buttons, no fixed-width labels
Interaction states	Pressed state on buttons; visible keyboard focus outline specified for implementation
Motion	Sprig motion is subtle and switches off for reduced-motion settings



Sprig states: hello, checking, waiting, done. Used at Welcome and Waiting.



Style guide / visual system.

9. Performance and success metrics

IMPLEMENTATION CONSIDERATIONS AND WHAT TO TRACK

Performance and implementation

Constraint	Design / build approach	Status
Page weight under 1.5MB	No video, no live ticker, no popups; no images required for the first view; font subsets	To be measured on a real build
Animations under 100KB	Sprig as inline SVG with CSS-only motion	To be measured on a real build
Low-end phones, slower 4G	Text-first layout, simple components, system-font fallback	To be tested on a low-end device
1 developer, about 3 weeks	Small component set reused across homepage and onboarding; no framework required	Planning assumption

These are build approaches, not measured results.

Success metrics to track

These are **success metrics to track**. No results have been achieved or measured.

Metric	Baseline	Target
Download → KYC conversion	22.5%	To be set after a pilot
KYC completion / drop-off	62% drop-off (cause unconfirmed)	Lower drop-off; set after tracking each KYC step
KYC → first investment	33.3%	Monitor; no regression
Time to first investment	Not provided	Establish a baseline first
Waiting-state exits and "app crashed" support contacts	Not provided	Track weekly; expect decrease
Page weight / load on slower 4G	n/a	Under 1.5MB; measure on a low-end device

Because the paid-campaign bounce rate is noisy, metrics should be segmented by acquisition source.

10. Next tests and reflection

WHAT I WOULD VALIDATE, AND WHAT STAYS UNCERTAIN

Test	Question	Signal to watch
KYC readiness checklist	Does "Keep these ready" raise KYC completion?	KYC completion with vs without the checklist
Waiting-state comprehension	Do users understand the waiting screen and stay calm?	Comprehension check; waiting-state exits; support contacts
CTA copy	Does "Get started" perform differently from other clear CTAs?	Download → KYC conversion
Hindi / localised content	Does the layout and copy hold up in Hindi?	Completion by language; layout breaks
Trust and disclaimer comprehension	Do users notice and understand the risk disclaimer and trust copy?	Short comprehension check; "Can I lose money?" FAQ interactions
Step-level KYC analytics	Where inside KYC do users stop?	Drop-off by step; confirms or rejects the readiness hypothesis

Reflection

	Notes
What I learned	A constraint-first approach made trade-offs easier: every decision traced back to a user problem, a compliance rule or a build limit.
Decisions I would defend	Declining video, ticker and popups; showing the disclaimer upfront; designing for readiness and a calm waiting state instead of decoration.
What I would validate next	Whether the readiness checklist and the waiting copy change behaviour, with real first-time investors, including in Hindi.
What remains uncertain	The real cause of the 62% KYC drop-off; the real verification turnaround, which should be validated with operations before launch; final legal and trust wording, to be confirmed before launch.